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-Viel Spaß üben, Ömer

Englisch KA Vorbereitung 05.03.2025

Elements of short stories

-**Shorter** than a novel

-**few** characters

-told from the **point of view** of a **narrator**

-concerned with a **single event**, in **one or a few** significant **episodes/scenes** in **one setting**

-**open plot**

-**abrupt opening** and **ending**

-**rarely fully developed characters**, who are **disclosed in action + dramatic encounter**

-**reveals strengths and weaknesses of characters** through a decisive moment

-tries to produce a certain effect in readers mind through its **message**

-mostly presented as a **snapshot of life**

Writing a characterization of a fictional character

Language

-formal English

-Use **Present Tense**

-varying **sentence structure** and **linking words** to connect sentences

Introduction

-introductory sentence with **name** of the character, their **role** and the **source material** (Name of the Medium, Medium-type, Creator of the medium, Date of release and the Theme)

-make a **central claim** which you will prove or disprove later

Main Part

-Organize the main part in a **topical order** *(least important aspect for the central claim → most important aspect for the central claim)*

-**Quote from the text and explain the quotations**

-Characters in a medium can be characterized **directly** or **indirectly**

>**Direct characterization**: The **characters/narrator** in the medium tells the reader what the character is like (Example: My skinniness always surprised me)

>**Indirect characterization:** The reader is drawn to conclusions about a character based on what the characters say or do (Example: John owns books, he must be really smart)

Conclusion

-**Summarize** your main ideas without repeating them

-Refer back to your **central claim**

Discrimination and racism in fictional texts

(unconscious) cultural stereotypes – generalizations based primarily on membership of a cultural group without exception, usually refers to negative assumptions because it is unjust to individuals who vary from others in the same group/culture.

racial discrimination – practice of treating someone differently/poorly, because of the color of their skin.

othering – to treat or consider a person/ a group of people as alien to oneself/one's group (as because of different racial, sexual/cultural characteristics).

overt expression of racist attitudes – an individual's or group's words or actions that are consciously and openly racist such as racial slurs.

internalized racism – In a society where racial prejudice thrives, it's difficult for people of color to avoid absorbing the racist messages that constantly bombard them. Thus, people of color sometimes adopt a white supremacist mindset that results in self-hatred and hatred of their respective racial group.

Implicit racial bias – can cause individuals to unknowingly act in discriminatory ways. This doesn't mean that the individual is overtly racist, but rather that their perceptions have been shaped by experiences and these perceptions potentially result in biased thoughts or actions.

microaggression/subtle racism – a comment or action that subtly and often unconsciously or unintentionally expresses a prejudiced attitude toward a member of a marginalized group.

systemic racism – policies and practices that exist throughout a whole society or organization and that result in and support a continued unfair advantage to some people and unfair or harmful treatment of others based on race.

institutional racism – racial discrimination, inequality, exploitation and domination in organizational or institutional context, such as the labor market, a specific company or school.

Useful terms

Character Roles/Types

Protagonist/Hero*ine – the main/central character.

Antagonist – the enemy of the protagonist; a character who is opposed to, or in conflict with, the main character.

Minor character – a less important character.

Flat character – a character who can be described in a few words; his/her behavior is predictable, as he/she doesn't develop or learn and never surprises the reader.

Round character – a life-like, complex individual, he/she may be shown in different moods and usually develops/undergoes character development.

Literary terms

setting – The time and place in which a story occurs. The setting helps establish the mood and context of the narrative and can influence the characters and events.

author – The individual who writes a literary work. He/she is responsible for developing the plot, characters and themes of the story.

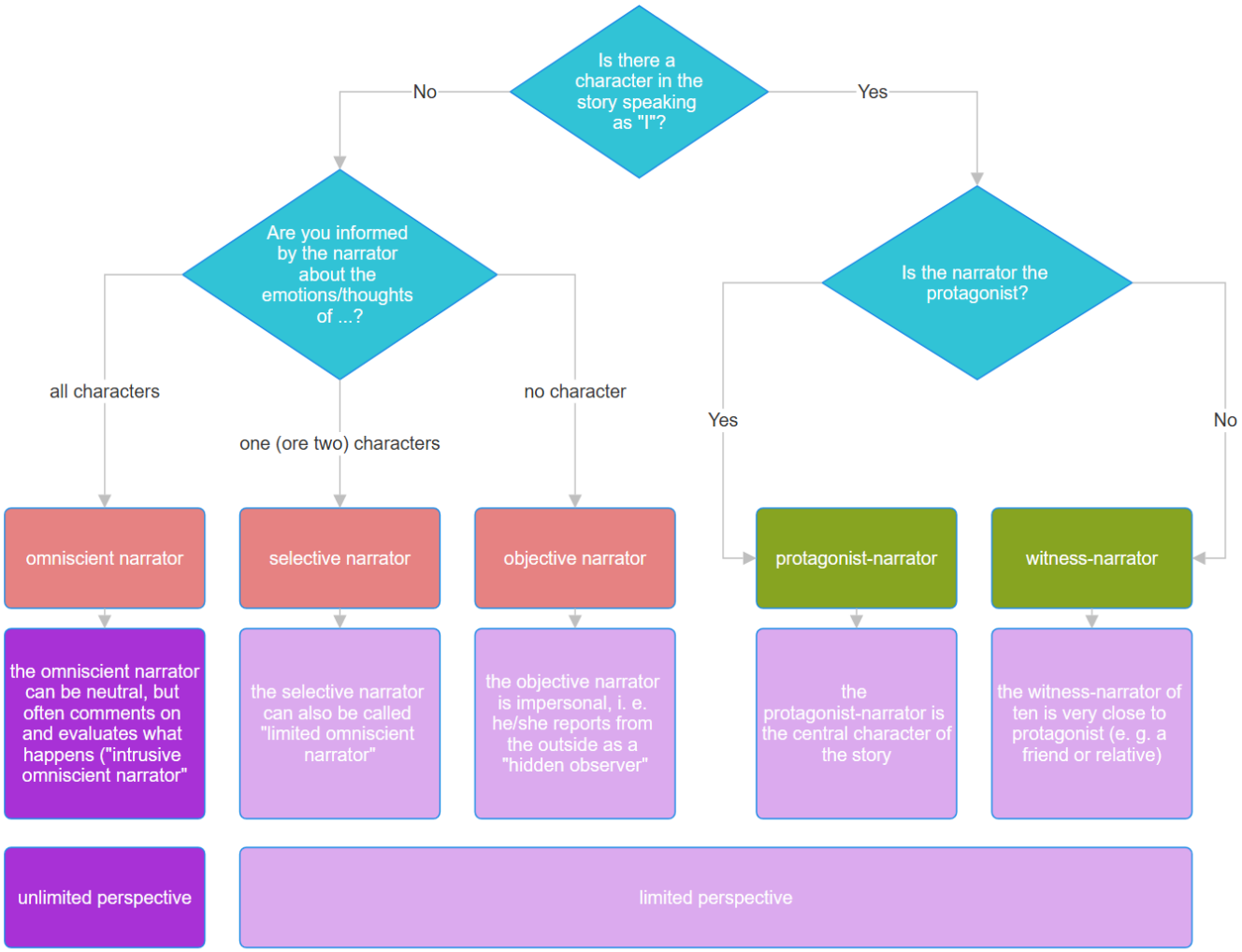
plot – The sequence of events that make up a story. It typically includes and introduction, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution, guiding the reader through the narrative.

short story – A brief work of fiction that usually focuses on a single incident or a character. They often have a concise plot and aim to evoke a specific mood/theme.

character – A person, animal or a figure in a story who plays a role in the narrative.

point of view – the perspective from which a story is told (Examples: First-Person and Third person limited/omniscient).

abrupt opening – A storytelling technique where a story begins suddenly, without much introduction/background information. This method can grab the reader's attention and create immediate interest.

snapshot of life – A brief depiction or moment that captures a specific aspect of a character's life or situation.

Narrator Types